5.2 Oil seeds and their importance

Oil is extracted from a range of oilseeds, fruits, nuts and seed kernels. However, not all oil bearing seeds and nuts contain edible oil. Some contain poisons or unpleasant flavours and are only used as thinner in paints.

A variety of vegetable oils are used for household cooking, and also as an ingredient for other food products such as baked items and snacks. Many oilseeds like mustard, corn, sunflower, sesame, palm and olive seeds are used everyday in various parts of our country for cooking purpose.

5.2.1 Mustard Seeds

- Mustard seeds are used for making mustard oil which is widely used for cooking in India.
- Mustard oil is a great oil substitute for traditional cooking oil as it is often used as a stimulant to help digestion and circulation.



Fig 5.6: Mustard

Due to its antibacterial properties, this oil can help protect the skin. It can also prevent cold, cough and skin problems.

5.2.2 Corn Oil

- Corn oil is a healthy edible oil.
- It is composed mainly of poly unsaturated fatty acids (PUFAs) and low on saturated fat.

5.2.3 Castor Seeds

- Castor seeds are used for making castor oil which is mostly used for beauty care purpose like hair care, skin care and other health benefits.
- Castor oil has a little higher viscosity so it is stickier than other types of oil.



Fig 5.7: Corn Oil



Fig 5.8: Castor Seeds

5.2.4 Sunflower Seeds

- Sunflower seeds are used for making sunflower oil which is widely used in cooking.
- It is low in carbohydrate and contains 40 percent fat and quality protein.
- Sunflower oil is a great option as it is a good source of vitamin E. It

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